



Sensory Overload Early Warning Signs

Identify personal early warning signs before overload

Sensory Integration

Ages 8–adult

2026 Clinical Guideline: This worksheet reflects updated 2026 best practices: strengths-based framing, individual autonomy, sensory-informed design, and co-regulation strategies. Adapt to the individual's communication style and preferences.

Personal Information

NAME

DATE

THERAPIST / PARENT

Activity

Physical signs

- ☐ Muscle tension increasing
- ☐ Breathing getting faster
- ☐ Skin flushing or going pale
- ☐ Clenching jaw or fists
- ☐ Feeling hot or cold suddenly

Emotional signs

- ☐ Irritability rising
- ☐ Feeling overwhelmed
- ☐ Wanting to escape
- ☐ Difficulty thinking clearly
- ☐ Feeling "about to explode"

Behavioral signs

- ☐ Pacing or fidgeting more

☐ Withdrawing from conversation

☐ Stimming more intensely

☐ Speaking louder or faster

☐ Refusing demands or requests

MY PERSONAL EARLY WARNING SIGNS

What do I notice before overload?

Notes & Reflections

WHAT WORKED WELL TODAY

Write or draw...

WHAT TO TRY DIFFERENTLY NEXT TIME

Write or draw...